

The Pregnancy Planner

A place to plan and prepare, week-by-week.

WEEKS 4 — 40

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

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Getting Started

 About this planner

 How to use it

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 Monthly overview

 Priorities & habits

 Weeks 4 – 12

2nd Trimester

 Monthly overview

 Priorities & habits

 Weeks 13 – 26

3rd Trimester

 Monthly overview

 Priorities & habits

 Weeks 27 – 40

Appointments

 Booking appointment (8 – 12 wks)

 Dating scan (11 – 14 wks)

 Anatomy scan (18 – 21 wks)

 Additional scans (template)

 Midwife appointments

Checklists

 Hospital bag

 Baby essentials

 Admin & work

 Postpartum care

 Signs of labour

 Questions for your midwife

 Questions at scan appts

Birth Plan

 Vaginal birth plan

 C-section birth plan

Journal

Notes

A note to close



A calm place for everything.

This planner is designed to hold everything pregnancy brings — the appointments, the tasks, the thoughts, and the questions. Not all at once. Just one week at a time.

Each weekly page gives you a gentle structure: a handful of suggested tasks to get you started, space to add your own, a habit tracker for the small daily things, and room to write how you're feeling.

There's no pressure to fill everything in. Use what helps. Leave what doesn't. This is your planner.

HOW TO USE IT

- Weekly pages run from Week 4 to Week 40, each colour-coded by trimester.
- Suggested tasks are pre-printed — tick them off, or ignore them.
- Blank checkboxes at the bottom of each section are yours to fill in.
- Each trimester title page has space to plan the habits you want to establish in that period. Those habits can then be tracked on each weekly page.
- The habit tracker runs Mon–Sun. Write your habit on the line, fill circles as you go.
- Appointments, checklists, your birth plan, and notes pages are at the back.

NAVIGATING YOUR PLANNER

- Tap any tab on the right edge to jump between sections.
- Tap any icon in the small nav bar at the top to jump between sections.
- Tap any underlined phrase inside a weekly to-do (e.g. 'dating scan') to jump straight to that page.
- In GoodNotes, links only work when the pen tool is off (Read-Only mode).
- To add more pages, duplicate any page: press and hold the page thumbnail, then select Duplicate.



1st Trimester

Weeks 1 – 12

START

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TO-DO LIST

SUN

- ☒ Book a GP appointment
- ☒ Start folic acid (400mcg daily)
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Add your weekly bump photo

[illegible]

NOTES

TO-DO LIST

SUN

Add your weekly bump photo

M T W T F S S

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NOTES

TO-DO LIST

SUN

Add your weekly bump photo

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NOTES

NOTES

TO-DO LIST

SUN

Add your weekly bump photo

M T W T F S S

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TO-DO LIST

SUN

Add your weekly bump photo

M T W T F S S

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2nd Trimester

Weeks 13 – 26

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1ST TRIMESTER

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TO-DO LIST

- ☐ Book your [anatomy scan](#)
- ☐ Consider sharing pregnancy news more widely

WEEKLY BUMP

HABITS

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NOTES



DAILY PLANNER

MON

TUE

WED

THU

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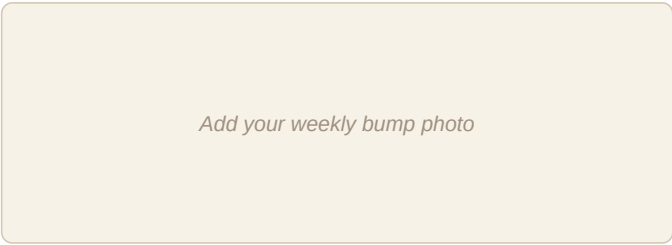
SAT

SUN

TO-DO LIST

- ☐ Start a baby names list if you'd like
- ☐ Explore antenatal class options — popular ones book up early
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

WEEKLY BUMP



HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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Notes section with horizontal lines for writing.

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- ☐ Attend your anatomy scan
- ☐ Note scan results and any follow-up needed
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

WEEKLY BUMP

Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

[illegible]

NOTES



DAILY PLANNER

MON

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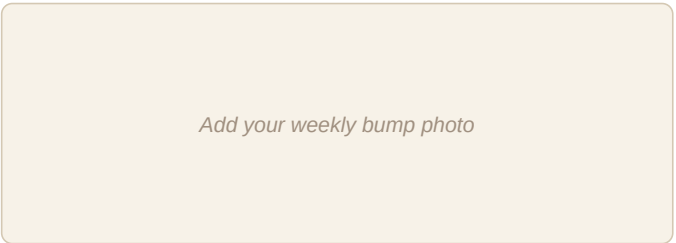
SUN

TO-DO LIST

- ☐ Discuss scan results with your midwife
- ☐ Start your hospital bag list formally

- ☐
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- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

WEEKLY BUMP



HABITS

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Notes section with horizontal lines for writing.

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SUN

Add your weekly bump photo

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NOTES



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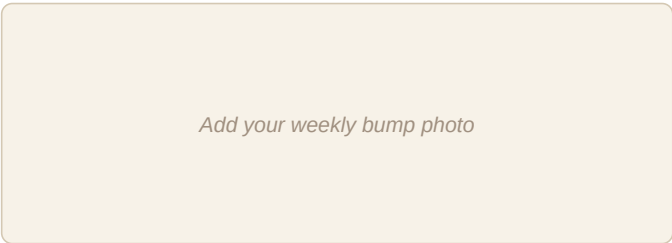
SAT

SUN

TO-DO LIST

- ☐ Book antenatal classes if not yet started
- ☐ Start a postpartum plan — meals, support, rest
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

WEEKLY BUMP



HABITS

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Notes section with horizontal lines for writing.

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TO-DO LIST

- ☐ Attend midwife appointment
- ☐ Review your baby budget and priorities

WEEKLY BUMP

HABITS

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NOTES

SUN

NOTES



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TO-DO LIST

☐ Submit maternity leave paperwork to HR

☐ Confirm your last working day in writing



WEEKLY BUMP

Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

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3rd Trimester

Weeks 27 – 40

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3RD TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

1ST TRIMESTER

START



3rd Trimester

Weeks 27 – 40

You're in the home stretch — and you're more ready than you feel.

Things might feel heavier now — physically and emotionally. That's real, and it's okay. Your body is preparing for something remarkable, and it's allowed to take up space doing so.

This trimester is about getting ready, not perfect. A bag packed. A few preferences written down. A little more rest wherever you can find it. The to-do list in this planner will feel manageable because it is — it's been designed so nothing sneaks up on you.

You don't need to have everything figured out. You just need to show up. And you already are.

PRIORITIES

- 1 Finalise your hospital bag, car seat, birth preferences, and postpartum essentials.
- 2 Attend more frequent midwife appointments and know the signs of labour.
- 3 Slow down. Stock the freezer. Set up your support network for after birth.

HABITS TO BUILD THIS TRIMESTER

- e.g. Practise breathing techniques
- e.g. Prepare freezer meals

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TO-DO LIST

☐ Attend midwife appointment (blood tests this week)

☐ Review your birth preferences document



WEEKLY BUMP

Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

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TO-DO LIST

☐ Finalise nursery essentials purchases

☐ Install or plan for baby's car seat

☐☐☐☐☐

WEEKLY BUMP

Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

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TO-DO LIST

- ☐ Start packing your [hospital bag](#)
- ☐ Confirm your birth partner's availability around your due date
- ☐
- ☐
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- ☐
- ☐

WEEKLY BUMP

Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

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TO-DO LIST

☐ Attend antenatal class if still in session

☐ Talk through your birth preferences with your midwife

WEEKLY BUMP

Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

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NOTES

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HABITS

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NOTES



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SUN

TO-DO LIST

☐ Finalise your birth preferences document

☐ Prepare your home for baby's arrival



WEEKLY BUMP

Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

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THU

FRI

SAT

SUN

TO-DO LIST

☐ Weekly midwife appointments begin from now

☐ Install car seat and check fitting

☐ Stock up on postpartum essentials for yourself

☐☐☐☐☐

WEEKLY BUMP

Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

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TO-DO LIST

☐ Attend weekly midwife appointment

☐ Tie up any loose ends at home



WEEKLY BUMP

Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
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NOTES

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TO-DO LIST

☐ Stay in contact with your midwife

☐ Rest, breathe, trust yourself



WEEKLY BUMP

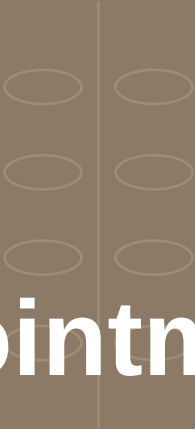
Add your weekly bump photo

HABITS

M T W T F S S



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Appointments

Booking, scans, midwife appointments

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Your first official appointment — usually with your community midwife. Lasts around an hour. You'll talk through your medical history, options for screening, and what NHS care will look like from here.

DATE	TIME

WEEK	PROVIDER	LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

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NEXT STEPS

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Confirms how many weeks pregnant you are and your estimated due date. Usually combined with screening blood tests on the same day.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

SONOGRAPHER

LOCATION

ESTIMATED DUE DATE

SCAN PHOTO

Add your scan photo here

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

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A detailed scan checking baby's growth and development — heart, brain, spine, kidneys, limbs, and the position of the placenta. You may also choose to find out the baby's sex.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

SONOGRAPHER

LOCATION

SCAN PHOTO

Add your scan photo here

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

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Use this template for any extra scan that doesn't fall within the standard dating or anatomy scan timings — for example, a growth scan, reassurance scan, or follow-up. To add more pages: press and hold the page thumbnail in GoodNotes and select Duplicate.

DATE	TIME	
SCAN TYPE		
WEEK	SONOGRAPHER	LOCATION
SCAN PHOTO		



Add your scan photo here

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

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FIRST-TIME MUMS ONLY

This 25-week appointment is only routinely offered to first-time mums in the UK.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

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DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

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FIRST-TIME MUMS ONLY

This 31-week appointment is only routinely offered to first-time mums in the UK.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

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TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

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TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

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DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

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FIRST-TIME MUMS ONLY

This 40-week appointment is only routinely offered to first-time mums in the UK.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

NOTES

NEXT STEPS

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TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

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NEXT STEPS

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Use this template for any midwife appointment that doesn't fall within the standard NHS schedule above. To add more pages: press and hold the page thumbnail in GoodNotes and select Duplicate.

DATE

TIME

WEEK

MIDWIFE

LOCATION

QUESTIONS TO ASK

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NEXT STEPS



Checklists

Stay organised, one step at a time

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1ST TRIMESTER

START

FOR YOU — LABOUR

- ☐ Maternity notes
- ☐ Birth plan (printed copy)
- ☐ ID and hospital paperwork
- ☐ Phone and long charger cable
- ☐ Pillow from home
- ☐ Lip balm
- ☐ Hair ties / hairband
- ☐ Snacks (high-energy)
- ☐ Water bottle with straw
- ☐ Flip-flops for the shower
- ☐ TENS machine (if using)
- ☐ Mints / lozenges

FOR YOU — AFTER BIRTH

- ☐ Nightgown / front-opening pyjamas
- ☐ Dressing gown
- ☐ Slippers
- ☐ Comfortable underwear (x5+)
- ☐ Nursing bras (x2)
- ☐ Maternity pads (2 packs)
- ☐ Breast pads
- ☐ Toiletries: toothbrush, dry shampoo, face wipes
- ☐ Going-home outfit (loose)

FOR BABY

- ☐ Sleepsuits / babygros (x3)
- ☐ Vests (x3)
- ☐ Hat (x2)
- ☐ Scratch mitts
- ☐ Socks
- ☐ Cardigan
- ☐ Going-home outfit
- ☐ Nappies (newborn pack)
- ☐ Cotton wool / wipes
- ☐ Muslin cloths (x4)
- ☐ Car seat (fitted in car)
- ☐ Blanket
- ☐ Snowsuit / weather layer (if winter)

FOR YOUR PARTNER

- ☐ Change of clothes
- ☐ Toiletries
- ☐ Snacks and drinks
- ☐ Phone and charger
- ☐ Camera
- ☐ Pillow
- ☐ Cash / card for parking



SLEEPING

- ☐ Cot or Moses basket
- ☐ Mattress (firm, flat, new if possible)
- ☐ Fitted sheets (x3)
- ☐ Sleeping bags (x2, age-appropriate tog)
- ☐ Cellular blankets
- ☐ Baby monitor
- ☐ Blackout blind or cover

FEEDING

- ☐ Nursing pillow
- ☐ Bottles and steriliser (if using formula or pumping)
- ☐ Breast pump (if planning to express)
- ☐ Bibs (x6)
- ☐ Muslin cloths (x10)
- ☐ Bottle brush

CLOTHING (NEWBORN)

- ☐ Sleepsuits / babygros (x7)
- ☐ Vests (x7)
- ☐ Cardigan (x2)
- ☐ Hats (x2)
- ☐ Socks (x3 pairs)
- ☐ Scratch mitts

BATHING

- ☐ Baby bath or bath support
- ☐ Hooded towels (x2)
- ☐ Gentle baby wash
- ☐ Cotton wool

CHANGING

- ☐ Changing mat
- ☐ Changing bag
- ☐ Nappies (newborn pack)
- ☐ Nappy cream
- ☐ Wipes (sensitive)
- ☐ Nappy disposal bin or sacks

OUT AND ABOUT

- ☐ Pram / pushchair
- ☐ Car seat (essential)
- ☐ Sling or carrier (optional)
- ☐ Pram blanket / footmuff
- ☐ Rain cover



DURING PREGNANCY — WORK & HR

- ☐ Notify employer of pregnancy in writing (by week 25)
- ☐ Request a workplace risk assessment
- ☐ Submit MATB1 form once received from midwife
- ☐ Confirm maternity leave start date with HR
- ☐ Discuss enhanced maternity pay (if applicable)
- ☐ Plan a handover for your role

DURING PREGNANCY — FINANCES & ADMIN

- ☐ Check NHS entitlements — free prescriptions and dental
- ☐ Apply for Maternity Allowance (if self-employed)
- ☐ Research Child Benefit (apply after birth)
- ☐ Update wills, insurance, or pension if needed
- ☐ Open a savings account for baby (optional)

AFTER BIRTH

- ☐ Register the birth (within 42 days in England & Wales)
- ☐ Apply for Child Benefit
- ☐ Notify HMRC of new child
- ☐ Add baby to your health insurance
- ☐ Register baby with a GP
- ☐ Apply for childcare hours (15 / 30 free hours)
- ☐ Inform employer of return-to-work date



The fourth trimester is yours too. Stock up on these before baby arrives so you can rest and recover at home without worrying about errands.

BLEEDING & RECOVERY

- ☐ Maternity pads (3+ packs — heavy flow)
- ☐ Disposable underwear or old pants
- ☐ Peri bottle (for rinsing perineum)
- ☐ Witch hazel pads / sitz spray
- ☐ Cooling pads / ice packs
- ☐ Donut cushion (if perineum sore)

BREASTFEEDING

- ☐ Nipple cream (lanolin or coconut)
- ☐ Breast pads (disposable or washable)
- ☐ Nursing bras (x3, soft cotton)
- ☐ Nursing tops or button-front pyjamas
- ☐ Haakaa or silicone pump
- ☐ Heat / cold packs for breasts

REST & COMFORT

- ☐ Loose, comfortable clothing
- ☐ Robe with pockets
- ☐ Slippers
- ☐ Phone charger by the bed
- ☐ Easy-access snacks and water
- ☐ Pillow for nursing position

RECOVERY FROM C-SECTION

- ☐ High-waisted underwear (above the scar)
- ☐ Loose drawstring trousers
- ☐ Scar care: silicone strips or gel
- ☐ Stool softener (ask GP/midwife)
- ☐ Help with stairs and lifting

EMOTIONAL & PRACTICAL

- ☐ List of who to call if you feel low
- ☐ Meal train or batch-cooked freezer meals
- ☐ Pre-arranged help with older children / pets
- ☐ Plan for visitors: how, when, who



Knowing what to look out for — and what's reassuring — helps you feel calmer in the days and weeks before birth. Always trust your instincts and call your midwife or hospital if anything worries you.

EARLY SIGNS

- ☐ A 'show' — pink or blood-tinged mucus plug
- ☐ Mild cramping or backache that comes and goes
- ☐ Nesting urge — sudden energy and tidying
- ☐ Loose stools or upset stomach
- ☐ Baby moving lower into the pelvis ('lightening')
- ☐ Braxton Hicks contractions becoming more frequent

ACTIVE LABOUR

- ☐ Regular contractions getting longer, stronger, closer together
- ☐ Contractions you can't talk through
- ☐ Waters breaking — clear / pale fluid (note time and colour)
- ☐ Strong urge to bear down (in established labour)

CALL YOUR MIDWIFE / HOSPITAL IF...

- ☐ Contractions are 5 minutes apart, lasting 60 seconds, for 1 hour (5-1-1)
- ☐ Your waters break — even if not in labour yet
- ☐ Waters are green, brown, or blood-stained
- ☐ You notice reduced or changed baby movements
- ☐ You have bright red bleeding (more than a smear)
- ☐ Severe or persistent headache, visual changes, or swelling
- ☐ You feel something isn't right — trust that feeling



Prompts to think through before each appointment. Pick the ones that matter most to you — don't feel you need to ask every single one.

FIRST TRIMESTER

- ☐ What screening tests are offered and when?
- ☐ Which vitamins do I need to take?
- ☐ Are my current medications safe to continue?
- ☐ What symptoms should I report?
- ☐ How do I contact you between appointments?

SECOND TRIMESTER

- ☐ Is my baby growing as expected?
- ☐ What does this scan / blood test result mean?
- ☐ When will I feel movements? What should they feel like?
- ☐ How do I start a birth plan?
- ☐ Which antenatal classes do you recommend?

THIRD TRIMESTER

- ☐ How is baby positioned?
- ☐ What are my pain relief options?
- ☐ When should I come into hospital?
- ☐ What if I go past my due date?
- ☐ What happens if I need an induction or C-section?
- ☐ How do I monitor baby's movements at home?

APPROACHING / AFTER 40 WEEKS

- ☐ What does my induction pathway look like?
- ☐ What is a membrane sweep and what does it involve?
- ☐ What if I want to wait — and what are the risks?
- ☐ What postnatal support is available locally?
- ☐ When will my postnatal check be?



Use these prompts for both your dating scan and anatomy scan. Sonographers welcome questions — but they may not be able to discuss everything in detail. Your midwife will follow up on results.

AT THE DATING SCAN (11 – 14 weeks)

- ☐ Is everything developing as expected?
- ☐ Is there one baby — or more?
- ☐ What's my updated due date?
- ☐ What does the nuchal translucency measurement show?
- ☐ What happens with the combined screening results?
- ☐ When and how will I get my results?

AT THE ANATOMY SCAN (18 – 21 weeks)

- ☐ Is baby's growth on track?
- ☐ Are all the major organs developing as expected?
- ☐ Where is the placenta positioned?
- ☐ Is the amniotic fluid level normal?
- ☐ Can you tell me the sex of the baby (if I want to know)?
- ☐ Do I need a follow-up scan, and if so, when?
- ☐ When and how will I get the full report?

ANY SCAN — GENERAL

- ☐ What did you see today that you'd like the midwife to follow up?
- ☐ Is there anything I should monitor at home?
- ☐ Are there any signs I should call about urgently?



Birth Plan

Vaginal birth · C-section



OVERVIEW

DUE DATE	BIRTH PARTNER — NAME
PREFERRED LOCATION	BIRTH PARTNER — CONTACT
DIETARY REQUIREMENTS / ALLERGIES	

DURING LABOUR — SET UP

WHO I WANT IN THE ROOM	ENVIRONMENT PREFERENCES
☐ Birth partner only	☐ Dim lights / fairy lights
☐ No trainees / observers, please	☐ Music from my playlist
☐ Limited interruptions where possible	☐ Aromatherapy / oils
☐ Same midwife where possible	☐ Quiet talking / minimal interruption

HYDRATION

☐ Drinking water / oral fluids as I want

☐ IV fluids only if medically necessary

☐ Ice chips if requested

BIRTHING POSITIONS — WHAT I'D LIKE TO TRY

☐ Upright / standing

☐ On all fours

☐ Side-lying

☐ Water birth (if available)

☐ Birthing ball

☐ Squatting

☐ Whatever feels right in the moment



PAIN RELIEF — IN ORDER OF PREFERENCE

- ☐ No pain relief unless I ask
- ☐ Hypnobirthing techniques / breathing
- ☐ TENS machine
- ☐ Water (bath / pool)
- ☐ Gas and air (Entonox)
- ☐ Pethidine / Diamorphine
- ☐ Epidural
- ☐ Whatever I decide on the day

BABY MONITORING & INTERVENTIONS

- ☐ Intermittent monitoring (preferred)
- ☐ Continuous monitoring only if medically needed
- ☐ Avoid routine vaginal examinations where possible
- ☐ Discuss any intervention with me before it happens

IF ASSISTED DELIVERY BECOMES NEEDED

- ☐ Forceps — discuss with me first
- ☐ Ventouse (vacuum) — discuss with me first
- ☐ Episiotomy — only if necessary, please discuss
- ☐ Unplanned C-section — see my C-section plan

SECOND STAGE — PUSHING

- ☐ Spontaneous pushing — follow my body
- ☐ Coached pushing only if needed
- ☐ Mirror to see baby being born
- ☐ Partner to help guide baby out (if possible)

ANYTHING ELSE



DELAYED CORD CLAMPING

- ☐ Yes — please wait at least 1–3 minutes
- ☐ Yes — until the cord stops pulsating
- ☐ Cord blood banking arranged (private)
- ☐ Partner to cut the cord (if possible)

IMMEDIATE SKIN-TO-SKIN

- ☐ Yes — on my chest immediately if safe
- ☐ Partner to do skin-to-skin if I can't
- ☐ Delay weighing / measuring until after first feed

PLACENTA

- ☐ Active management — injection to deliver placenta
- ☐ Physiological — wait and deliver naturally
- ☐ I'd like to see the placenta
- ☐ We'd like to take the placenta home

FEEDING

- ☐ Breastfeeding — please support first latch
- ☐ Formula feeding from the start
- ☐ Combination feeding
- ☐ Undecided — please support whichever I choose

BABY'S FIRST CHECKS

- ☐ Vitamin K — injection (preferred)
- ☐ Vitamin K — oral doses
- ☐ Decline vitamin K
- ☐ Newborn checks done with me / partner present

IF NICU OR SCBU IS NEEDED

- ☐ Partner to stay with baby at all times
- ☐ Skin-to-skin as soon as it's possible
- ☐ Pump milk for baby as soon as I can
- ☐ Updates every step of the way, please

MY POSTPARTUM CHECKS

- ☐ Privacy for any examinations
- ☐ Same midwife where possible
- ☐ Pain relief offered if needed



Whether planned or unplanned, a C-section is still your birth. These preferences help keep the experience close to what you want, where it's safely possible.

OVERVIEW

DUE DATE / PLANNED DATE	BIRTH PARTNER — NAME
HOSPITAL	
DIETARY REQUIREMENTS / ALLERGIES	

IN THEATRE

- ☐ Birth partner present throughout
- ☐ Music from my playlist played
- ☐ Drape lowered at the moment of birth (if safe)
- ☐ Quiet talking / commentary as baby is born
- ☐ Explanations from the team as it happens

AS BABY IS BORN

- ☐ Delayed cord clamping where possible
- ☐ Immediate skin-to-skin with me (if safe)
- ☐ Skin-to-skin with partner if I can't
- ☐ Cord blood banking arranged (private)
- ☐ Photos / video allowed

FEEDING & FIRST CHECKS

- ☐ Support for first breastfeed in recovery
- ☐ Formula feeding from the start
- ☐ Vitamin K — injection
- ☐ Vitamin K — oral
- ☐ Baby's newborn checks done with me present

MY RECOVERY

- ☐ Help with first feed when I'm ready
- ☐ Pain relief explained and offered
- ☐ Help mobilising slowly when safe
- ☐ Privacy for examinations

ANYTHING ELSE

START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES



Journal

Words for the days you want to remember

NOTES

JOURNAL

BIRTH PLAN

CHECKLISTS

APPOINTMENTS

3RD TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

1ST TRIMESTER

START



START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

APPOINTMENTS

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START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

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START

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3RD TRIMESTER

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APPOINTMENTS

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START

1ST TRIMESTER

2ND TRIMESTER

3RD TRIMESTER

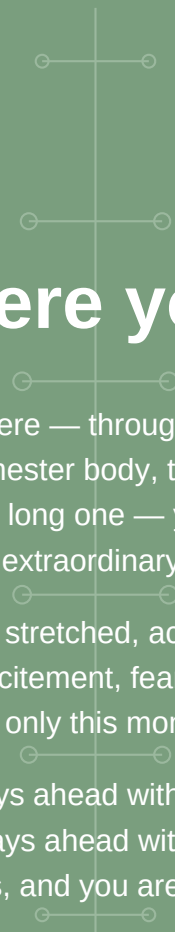
APPOINTMENTS

CHECKLISTS

BIRTH PLAN

JOURNAL

NOTES



And here you are.

However you arrived here — through long nights of nausea, the weight of a third trimester body, the rush of a quick labour or the slow patience of a long one — you have done something extraordinary.

Your body has grown, stretched, ached, and remade itself. Your mind has held excitement, fear, joy, and the quiet kind of love that only this moment makes.

There will be more days ahead with their own kind of hard. There will be more days ahead with their own kind of joy. Both are yours, and you are ready for both.

Wishing you slow mornings, soft landings, and a deep, settled love with your new baby.

Welcome to the rest of it.